EgoTECH

USER MANUAL

EgoTECH PDF Vault — Document & Image Storage System

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Preface

This User Manual describes how to install, configure, and use the EgoTECH PDF Vault application (version 1.0). It is intended for end-users of the system as well as administrators responsible for deployment and maintenance.

For technical specifications and requirements, refer to the accompanying Software Requirements Specification (SRS) document.

1. Getting Started

1.1 System Requirements

Component	Minimum Requirement
Operating System	Windows 10/11, macOS 12+, or Ubuntu 20.04+
Python	3.10 or later (3.13 recommended)
Node.js	18.0 or later
npm	9.0 or later
Web Browser	Chrome 110+, Firefox 110+, Edge 110+, or Safari 16+
Disk Space	500 MB free (plus space for stored files)
RAM	512 MB minimum; 2 GB recommended

1.2 Installation

Step 1 — Download the Project

Clone or download the project repository to your local machine.

Step 2 — Configure the Backend

Open a terminal and navigate to the backend folder:

```
cd PDF-Storage-System\backend
```

Copy the example environment file:

```
copy .env.example .env          (Windows)
cp .env.example .env            (macOS / Linux)
```

Open .env in a text editor and review the settings. At minimum, change AUTH_SECRET to a long random string.

Step 3 — Install Backend Dependencies

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Step 4 — Install Frontend Dependencies

Open a second terminal and navigate to the frontend folder:

```
cd PDF-Storage-System\frontend
npm install
```

2. Starting the Application

2.1 Start the Backend Server

In your backend terminal, run:

```
python -m uvicorn app.main:app --reload --port 8000
```

The backend API will be accessible at http://localhost:8000. Interactive API documentation is available at http://localhost:8000/docs.

2.2 Start the Frontend Server

In your frontend terminal, run:

```
npm run dev
```

The web application will be accessible at http://localhost:5173. Open this URL in your browser.

⚠Important: Both servers must be running at the same time for the application to function correctly.

3. User Account Management

3.1 Registering a New Account

1. Open your browser and navigate to http://localhost:5173.
2. On the Login page, click Register (or the equivalent tab/link).
3. Enter a unique Username (3–80 characters).
4. Enter a unique Email address.
5. Enter a Password (8–128 characters).
6. Click Register. You will be automatically logged in and redirected to the Dashboard.

3.2 Logging In

7. Open http://localhost:5173 in your browser.
8. Enter your Email and Password.
9. Click Log In. On success you are taken to the Documents Dashboard.

3.3 Logging Out

Click the Log out button in the top-right corner of the application. Your session will end and you will be returned to the Login page.

3.4 Session Expiry

For security, your login session expires automatically after 60 minutes of inactivity (configurable via AUTH_TOKEN_MINUTES in .env). You will be redirected to the Login page and must log in again.

4. Documents Workspace

The Documents Workspace is the default view after login. It displays your PDF library organized by folders, along with storage statistics.

4.1 Understanding the Dashboard

Element	Description
Stats Bar	Shows total number of documents, total storage used, and file format information.
Folder Grid	Displays all your folders. Each card shows the folder name and the number of PDFs inside.
Search Bar	Appears when a folder is open. Filters documents by filename in real time.
Refresh Button	Reloads the document list from the server.
Upload PDF Button	Appears when a folder is open. Opens the upload panel.

4.2 Creating a Folder

10. On the Documents Dashboard, click + New folder.
11. A prompt will appear. Type the desired folder name (up to 120 characters).
12. Click OK. The new folder appears in the Folder Grid immediately.

Note: Folder names must be unique within your account. Duplicate names are rejected.

4.3 Opening a Folder

13. Click on any folder card in the Folder Grid.
14. The folder opens, displaying all PDFs stored inside it.
15. To return to the folder list, click ← All folders.

4.4 Uploading a PDF Document

16. Open a folder (you must be inside a folder to upload).
17. Click the Upload PDF button (top-right area or inside the empty folder prompt).
18. In the Upload Panel that appears, click Choose File or drag and drop a PDF.
19. The target folder is pre-selected. You may change it using the folder dropdown.
20. Click Upload. A success notice confirms the upload.

Restrictions:

- Only PDF files are accepted. Files must have a valid PDF header.
- Maximum file size: 25 MB per file.
- Free plan: maximum 3 uploads per day. A prompt to upgrade appears when the limit is reached.

4.5 Searching for a Document

21. Open a folder.
22. Type part of the filename in the Search documents by filename… box.
23. The document list filters in real time.

24. Clear the search box to show all documents in the folder again.

4.6 Downloading a Document

25. Locate the document card in the folder.
26. Click the Download button (↓ icon) on the card.
27. Your browser will download the PDF with its original filename.

4.7 Deleting a Document

28. Locate the document card in the folder.
29. Click the Delete button (🗑 icon) on the card.
30. A confirmation dialog appears. Click OK to permanently delete the document.

⚠Warning: Deletion is permanent and cannot be undone.

4.8 Deleting a Folder

31. On the Folder Grid, click the 🗑 (trash) icon on the folder card you want to remove.
32. A confirmation dialog warns you that PDFs inside will become uncategorised.
33. Click OK to delete the folder. The PDFs themselves are NOT deleted.

5. Images Workspace

The Images Workspace allows you to store and organize image files (JPEG, PNG, GIF, WEBP, BMP) within user-defined categories.

5.1 Switching to the Images Workspace

34. Click Images in the left sidebar.
35. The Images Workspace loads, showing your image categories.

5.2 Creating an Image Category

36. Click + New category.
37. Enter a category name and confirm.
38. The new category appears in the list.

5.3 Uploading Images

39. Click on a category to open it.
40. Click Upload Image.
41. Select an image file (JPEG, PNG, GIF, WEBP, or BMP, max 25 MB).
42. Click Upload. The image appears in the gallery.

5.4 Viewing Images

Images are displayed in a grid gallery inside the category. You can search images by filename using the search bar.

5.5 Deleting an Image

43. Click the 🗑 delete icon on the image card.
44. Confirm deletion. The image is permanently removed.

5.6 Deleting a Category

45. Click the delete icon on the category card.
46. Confirm deletion. ALL images in the category are permanently deleted along with the category.

⚠Warning: Deleting a category deletes all images inside it. This cannot be undone.

6. Plans & Limits

Feature	Free Plan	Pro Plan
PDF Uploads per Day	3	Unlimited
Image Uploads	Unlimited	Unlimited
Folder Creation	Unlimited	Unlimited
Category Creation	Unlimited	Unlimited
File Size Limit	25 MB per file	25 MB per file
Storage Limit	Disk-based (no artificial limit)	Disk-based (no artificial limit)
Price	Free	Pro (see Plans page)

6.1 Upgrading to Pro

47. Click Plans in the footer or sidebar, or click View plans in the upgrade prompt.
48. Review the plan comparison on the Plans page.
49. Click Activate Pro. Your session is immediately upgraded to the Pro plan.

Note: In v1.0, plan activation is session-local and resets on logout. Persistent billing integration is planned for v2.0.

7. Configuration Reference (.env)

The backend is configured via the backend/.env file. The following variables are available:

Variable	Default Value	Description
APP_NAME	PDF Vault API	Name displayed in API metadata
API_PREFIX	/api/v1	URL prefix for all API routes
CORS_ORIGINS	http://localhost:5173,…	Allowed frontend origins (comma-separated)
MAX_UPLOAD_MB	25	Maximum upload size in megabytes
STORAGE_DIR	storage/pdfs	Filesystem path for stored files
DATABASE_URL	sqlite:///./storage/pdf_vault.db	SQLAlchemy database connection URL
AUTH_SECRET	(must be set)	Secret key for JWT signing — MUST be changed in production
AUTH_TOKEN_MINUTES	60	JWT expiry duration in minutes

8. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely Cause	Solution
'No module named uvicorn' error	Backend dependencies not installed	Run: pip install -r requirements.txt
Cannot connect to backend	Backend server not running	Start with: python -m uvicorn app.main:app --reload --port 8000
Login always fails with 401	Wrong email/password	Ensure you registered with the exact email you are entering
Upload rejected (415 error)	File is not a valid PDF or wrong type	Ensure the file is a genuine PDF (not renamed)
Upload rejected (413 error)	File exceeds size limit	Compress the file or increase MAX_UPLOAD_MB in .env
'Folder not found' on upload	Folder was deleted during session	Refresh the page and select a valid folder
Session expires unexpectedly	Token lifetime too short	Increase AUTH_TOKEN_MINUTES in .env
Cannot see my documents	Wrong folder selected or backend offline	Check the selected folder and verify the backend is running

9. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Can I access my documents from another computer?

In the default localhost setup, no. The application runs locally and data is stored on the machine where the server is running. To enable remote access, deploy the backend on a server with a public IP and update CORS_ORIGINS accordingly.

Q: What happens to my PDFs when I delete a folder?

Your PDF files are NOT deleted. They become uncategorised (no folder assigned) and will no longer appear in any folder view. They remain in the database and on disk until you explicitly delete each one.

Q: Is my data safe?

Passwords are stored as bcrypt hashes and are never retrievable in plaintext. API access requires a valid JWT token. Each user can only access their own documents. For production use, ensure AUTH_SECRET is a strong random value and consider enabling HTTPS.

Q: Can I store files other than PDFs?

In the Documents Workspace, only PDF files are accepted. The Images Workspace accepts JPEG, PNG, GIF, WEBP, and BMP files.

Q: How do I back up my data?

Back up the following paths from the backend directory:

- storage/pdf_vault.db — the SQLite database containing all records.

- storage/pdfs/ — all uploaded PDF files and images.

10. Contact & Support

For support, questions, or feedback, please contact the EgoTECH team:

- Email: support@egotech.com
- Website: https://egotech.com
- API Documentation (local): http://localhost:8000/docs